



## SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

|               |     |                |                    |              |            |
|---------------|-----|----------------|--------------------|--------------|------------|
| <b>Ref:</b>   | 066 | <b>Author:</b> | D Bibby            | <b>Date:</b> | 08.02.2024 |
| <b>Topic:</b> |     |                | <b>AIR QUALITY</b> |              |            |

***This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.***

There are several ways both indoor and outdoor air quality can affect our health. Fumes and construction/demolition projects can introduce many contaminants into the air we breathe.

**Outdoor** air quality can be affected by many factors, including:

- weather, from extreme heat and humidity to extreme cold and wind chill
- cumulated exhaust fumes from machinery
- air pollution
- pollen

**Indoor** air quality has a significantly higher number of potential hazards, including:

- chemicals
- dusts
- moulds or fungi
- bacteria
- gases, vapours, odours
- no airflow
- extremely warm or cold air
- hydrogen sulphide (H<sub>2</sub>S)
- carbon monoxide (CO)
- carbon dioxide (CO<sub>2</sub>)
- fiberglass
- asbestos
- volatile organic compounds (VOCs)
- solvents

**Investigate Potential Hazards**

Assess the environment, site, facilities, and materials for potential contaminants before the job begins. Continue to identify potential hazards and control through regular worksite inspections and hazard assessments, which should include air quality assessments.

**Develop Procedures**

Prepare safe work practices and specific safe job procedures for each job task. Job procedures should list potential hazards and contain specific detailed steps that list controls, engineering methods, and personal protective equipment (PPE).

**Employee Awareness**

Review job procedures and practices on how to control contaminants and educate the people that will be working at the specific sites. Educate staff with awareness classes on specific subjects, such as Asbestos and Silicosis, and keep workforce up to date with regular training.

**Discussion Points**

Are you aware of where to find relevant information on the effects of substance to your health (coshh)?

Do you have the correct PPE to conduct your work (ie mask for paint booth)?